perhaps because he had reached Herī without any equipment and resources. He had turned an absolute importunate. Muḥammad Barandūq retorted, ‘When you had thirty thousand men behind you and the whole country in your hands, what did you effect against the Aūzbeg? What will you do now with your five hundred men and the Aūzbegs in possession?’

Babur has written, ‘He added a little good advice in a few sensible words, but all was in vain because the fated hour of Khusrau Shāh’s death was near.’

At last, he was granted leave for his importunity. Khusrau Shāh with his 400-odd followers went straight into the borders of Dahānah. Praise to the play of stars, Nāṣir Mīrzā and he had to meet. Latter had just gone across—as told in chapter 18.

Now, the Badakhshī chiefs had invited only the Nāṣir Mīrzā and not Khusrau Shāh. Mīrzā tried his best to persuade Khusrau Shāh to go into the hill country (perhaps Ḥiṣār). The latter was quite hesitant to act on Mīrzā’s suggestion. He believed that if he marched under the Mīrzā, he would get the country into his own hands. At last, both didn’t agree with each other. Finally, he arrayed Mīrzā and his following near Ishkīmīsh, put on mail, drawing out to fight and departed. Nāṣir Mīrzā went on for Badakhshān. After collecting a muddled horde surmounting to around a thousand, good as well as bad, Khusrau Shāh went, intending to lay siege to Qūndūz and Khwāja Chār-tāq.

Shaybāni Khān, after incapacitating Sulṭān Aḥmad Taṃbal and Andijān, made a move on Ḥiṣār. Khusrau Shāh[6] ran away from his own country, Qūndūz, and Ḥiṣār without being struck by a single blow. He was dedicated to saving himself from even a scratch. Subsequently, Shaybāni Khān went to Ḥiṣār along with Sherīm and many other warriors. Ḥiṣār wasn’t surrendered, though as their honourable beg had run away from his own country it was an easy job to make Ḥiṣār secure. Having entrusted the siege of Ḥiṣār to Ḥamza Sulṭān and Mahdī Sulṭān, Shaybāni went to Qūndūz. He gave Qūndūz to his younger brother, Maḥmūd Sulṭān and he relocated to Khwārizm against Chīn Ṣūfī without any delay.

While he was already on the way to Khwārizm, somewhere near Samarkand he heard about the demise of his brother Maḥmūd Sulṭān way back in Qūndūz. We have no records of how he reacted to the incident, but we are told that he gave his place to Qaṃbar Bī of Marv.

Khusrau Shāh was furious upon hearing this and wanted to bring in some action. He sent off gallopers to summon Ḥamza Sulṭān and each one whom